

Timeline summary of *Sholay*

Key Milestones of *Sholay*

1975 – Original Release

Sholay, directed by Ramesh Sippy, originally released in 1975. The film told a gripping tale of friendship, justice, revenge and redemption, becoming a major cultural milestone in Indian cinema. (The Times of India)

1975 (Pre-release) – Censorship & Changed Ending

Originally, the film had a far more violent climax: the character Thakur Baldev Singh (played by Sanjeev Kumar) was meant to kill the villain Gabbar Singh (played by Amjad Khan) using a spiked shoe — an act of brutal vengeance. However, due to censorship pressures during the period (when the film certification board deemed the ending too violent), the climax was re-shot: in the released version, Gabbar survives and is arrested by police instead. This altered version was what audiences saw for decades. (India Today)

2025 – Restoration & Rediscovery

Fifty years after its debut, *Sholay* was chosen for a full restoration. In 2025, the restoration process brought back the film to its originally intended form: the restored print drew from archival film negatives and other preserved materials to reconstruct the film — including the previously censored climax and some deleted scenes. The restored version preserves original framing and sound, attempting faithful recovery of the creator's vision. (The Indian Express)

Early in 2025, the restored version of *Sholay* premiered internationally — at a prestigious film-festival screening in Italy. This marked the world-premiere of the “uncut, original” version. (The Indian Express)

December 12, 2025 – Nationwide Re-Release

To mark the 50th anniversary of the film, a 4K restored edition titled *Sholay – The Final Cut* is scheduled to be released across 1,500 theatres in India on December 12, 2025. This release brings the “original” ending back to public view — allowing long-time fans and new audiences alike to experience the film as it was first conceived. (The Times of India)

Industry reports describe the scale of this re-release as one of the largest ever for a classic Indian film — underscoring its lasting popularity, cultural impact, and enduring appeal. (Fortune India)